Retail Returns Policy

Version: 1.2 **Effective:** 2026-01-01

IMPORTANT: Synthetic educational policy. Not a real company's terms.

Purpose and scope

This synthetic policy governs returns for physical retail items purchased through the fictional Northstar Retail store. It is created for an educational assignment and is not a real merchant policy.

Standard return window

Most unused physical items may be returned within 30 calendar days after the recorded delivery date. The delivery date, not the order date, starts the return window.

Condition requirements

An item must be unused, in resalable condition, and include its standard accessories. Items showing use or damage beyond ordinary inspection require manual review.

Non-returnable items

Final-sale items and downloadable digital products are not eligible for standard returns. If an order record does not identify whether an item is final sale, do not assume; ask for clarification or escalate.

How to request a return

Before creating a return request, retrieve the order record and verify that the requesting customer owns the order. Check delivery status, delivery date, item type, final-sale flag, and the 30-day window.

Exceptions and uncertainty

If the delivery date is missing, ownership cannot be verified, or item condition is disputed, do not approve automatically. Explain what is missing and route for manual review.

Source metadata

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